

# Education Administration English

Instructor guide for advanced ESL learners working in education administration

**Audience: school administrators, curriculum coordinators, student-services staff, program directors, admissions teams, registrars, and education operations leaders**

**Focus:** An education administration English curriculum for enrollment, student support, curriculum planning, parent communication, faculty coordination, compliance, accreditation, and institutional decision-making.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

## Purpose and Course Logic

An education administration English curriculum for enrollment, student support, curriculum planning, parent communication, faculty coordination, compliance, accreditation, and institutional decision-making.

### Core language challenge

Advanced learners do not only need vocabulary. They need the ability to ask which standard applies, who owns the decision, what evidence is sufficient, what risk is being accepted, and how to disagree without sounding vague, defensive, or reckless.

Each module trains a realistic workplace pressure point with role-specific terms, decision language, pushback practice, and bounded decision activities learners can apply to their own work.

### Course objectives

- Use education administration terminology accurately in meetings, written updates, handoffs, escalations, reviews, and client or stakeholder conversations.
- Turn vague requests into specific questions about evidence, owner, deadline, constraint, risk, and decision rights.
- Push back on unsafe, unsupported, noncompliant, unrealistic, or poorly scoped proposals while preserving professional trust.
- Handle realistic dialogues from the field, including conflict, uncertainty, documentation gaps, customer or stakeholder pressure, and cross-functional disagreement.
- Select language that produces concise workplace outputs: briefing notes, escalation updates, meeting scripts, risk memos, decision records, and follow-up messages.

## Instructor Module Plans

### Module 1. Enrollment, Admissions, and Placement (90 minutes)

Discuss student fit and capacity with fairness and clarity.

#### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: admissions criteria, placement, capacity, equity.
- Explain the workplace tension: Admission criteria, placement evidence, capacity, and equity need transparent handling.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Accept the loudest families first.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a admissions decision rationale.

#### Customized scenario

##### Workplace pressure

A program has more qualified applicants than seats.

Accept the loudest families first.

Admission criteria, placement evidence, capacity, and equity need transparent handling.

#### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.

3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a admissions decision rationale.

## Module 2. Curriculum Planning and Learning Outcomes (90 minutes)

Connect course design to measurable learning outcomes.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: learning outcome, curriculum map, assessment, standard.
- Explain the workplace tension: Standards, outcomes, sequence, assessment, and workload must align.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Insert the new unit.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a curriculum alignment memo.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

A department wants to add content without changing assessments.

Insert the new unit.

Standards, outcomes, sequence, assessment, and workload must align.

### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a curriculum alignment memo.

## Module 3. Student Support and Intervention (90 minutes)

Discuss struggling students using evidence and support language.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: intervention, accommodation, attendance, student support.
- Explain the workplace tension: Attendance, assessment data, accommodations, behavior, and support plans need review.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Tell the family the student is not trying.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a student intervention plan.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

A student is failing multiple classes.

Tell the family the student is not trying.

Attendance, assessment data, accommodations, behavior, and support plans need review.

### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.

2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a student intervention plan.

## Module 4. Parent and Guardian Communication (90 minutes)

Handle emotionally charged conversations with clarity.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: guardian communication, discipline, appeal, confidentiality.
- Explain the workplace tension: Facts, policy, student privacy, appeal options, and empathy must be balanced.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Defend the school policy firmly.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a parent meeting script.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

A parent disputes a disciplinary decision.

Defend the school policy firmly.

Facts, policy, student privacy, appeal options, and empathy must be balanced.

### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a parent meeting script.

## Module 5. Faculty Coordination and Evaluation (90 minutes)

Give faculty feedback without vague judgment.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: rubric, grading policy, observation, professional development.
- Explain the workplace tension: Rubrics, grading policy, classroom evidence, and professional support are needed.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Say students are unhappy.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a faculty feedback note.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

A teacher receives complaints about inconsistent grading.

Say students are unhappy.

Rubrics, grading policy, classroom evidence, and professional support are needed.

### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a faculty feedback note.

## Module 6. Compliance, Records, and Privacy (90 minutes)

Explain record rules and student privacy.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: FERPA, student record, need to know, secure handling.
- Explain the workplace tension: Need-to-know access, secure handling, and privacy policy must be confirmed.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Send the files because the request is internal.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a records-access response.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

A staff member wants to share student records by email.

Send the files because the request is internal.

Need-to-know access, secure handling, and privacy policy must be confirmed.

### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a records-access response.

## Module 7. Accreditation and Program Review (90 minutes)

Use evidence language for institutional quality.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: accreditation, program review, evidence, action plan.
- Explain the workplace tension: Evidence, assessment cycle, action plan, and ownership must be documented.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Write that improvements are in progress.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a program review action plan.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

A program review finds weak outcome data.

Write that improvements are in progress.

Evidence, assessment cycle, action plan, and ownership must be documented.

## Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a program review action plan.

## Module 8. Budget, Staffing, and Institutional Priorities (90 minutes)

Discuss resource tradeoffs without mission drift.

### Learners should be able to

- Use these terms accurately: budget, staffing model, workload, sustainability.
- Explain the workplace tension: Workload, student impact, compliance, and sustainability need evaluation.
- Respond professionally when a stakeholder says: Ask existing staff to absorb it.
- Select the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and decision required for a resource tradeoff brief.

### Customized scenario

#### Workplace pressure

A school wants to launch a new program with no additional staff.

Ask existing staff to absorb it.

Workload, student impact, compliance, and sustainability need evaluation.

### Classroom sequence

1. Terminology selection: distinguish the term that names the decision variable from three plausible alternatives.
2. Risk triage: select the stakeholder, decision, evidence gap, operating constraint, and cost of being wrong from a bounded scenario set.
3. Pushback ladder: choose the strongest sequence from clarification to evidence-based objection to consequence to decision request.
4. Decision artifact check: select the facts, caveat, owner, and next action that belong in a resource tradeoff brief.

## Nomenclature and Jargon

These are classroom working definitions. Learners should adapt wording to their organization's policies, systems, and local regulatory environment.

### Enrollment, Admissions, and Placement

| Term                | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Collocations                                                       | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| admissions criteria | In education administration, admissions criteria is an approved rule or decision framework that sets what is permitted, required, or acceptable. Use it when teams need to discuss student fit and capacity with fairness and clarity. | apply the admissions criteria; comply with the admissions criteria | Contrast: admissions criteria is an approved rule or threshold, not an informal preference. Example: Please confirm which admissions criteria applies before we commit the team. |

| Term      | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Collocations                             | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| placement | In education administration, placement is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss student fit and capacity with fairness and clarity. | clarify placement;<br>document placement | Contrast: placement should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify placement and the evidence that supports it. |
| capacity  | Available people, assets, time, space, or system throughput for a given workload.                                                                                                                                          | clarify capacity;<br>document capacity   | Contrast: capacity should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify capacity and the evidence that supports it.   |
| equity    | In education administration, equity is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss student fit and capacity with fairness and clarity.    | clarify equity;<br>document equity       | Contrast: equity should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify equity and the evidence that supports it.       |

## Curriculum Planning and Learning Outcomes

| Term             | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Collocations                                           | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| learning outcome | In education administration, learning outcome is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to connect course design to measurable learning outcomes. | clarify learning outcome;<br>document learning outcome | Contrast: learning outcome should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify learning outcome and the evidence that supports it. |
| curriculum map   | In education administration, curriculum map is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to connect course design to measurable learning outcomes.   | clarify curriculum map;<br>document curriculum map     | Contrast: curriculum map should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify curriculum map and the evidence that supports it.     |
| assessment       | In education administration, assessment is a structured examination of evidence, process, or results used to reach a defensible conclusion. Use it when teams need to connect course design to measurable learning outcomes. | conduct a assessment;<br>document the assessment       | Contrast: assessment is a structured examination of evidence; it is not a conclusion reached before the evidence is checked. Example: The team will conduct a assessment before it recommends a corrective action.                  |
| standard         | In education administration, standard is an approved rule or decision framework that sets what is permitted, required, or acceptable. Use it when teams need to connect course design to measurable learning outcomes.       | apply the standard;<br>comply with the standard        | Contrast: standard is an approved rule or threshold, not an informal preference. Example: Please confirm which standard applies before we commit the team.                                                                          |

## Student Support and Intervention

| Term         | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Collocations                                   | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| intervention | In education administration, intervention is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss struggling students using evidence and support language. | clarify intervention;<br>document intervention | Contrast: intervention should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify intervention and the evidence that supports it. |

| Term            | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Collocations                                         | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| accommodation   | In education administration, accommodation is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss struggling students using evidence and support language.         | clarify accommodation;<br>document accommodation     | Contrast: accommodation should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify accommodation and the evidence that supports it.     |
| attendance      | In education administration, attendance is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss struggling students using evidence and support language.            | clarify attendance;<br>document attendance           | Contrast: attendance should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify attendance and the evidence that supports it.           |
| student support | In education administration, student support is a stakeholder category whose needs, eligibility, experience, or obligations affect the decision. Use it when teams need to discuss struggling students using evidence and support language. | clarify student support;<br>document student support | Contrast: student support should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify student support and the evidence that supports it. |

## Parent and Guardian Communication

| Term                   | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Collocations                                                       | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| guardian communication | In education administration, guardian communication is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to handle emotionally charged conversations with clarity. | clarify guardian communication;<br>document guardian communication | Contrast: guardian communication should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify guardian communication and the evidence that supports it. |
| discipline             | In education administration, discipline is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to handle emotionally charged conversations with clarity.             | clarify discipline;<br>document discipline                         | Contrast: discipline should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify discipline and the evidence that supports it.                         |
| appeal                 | In education administration, appeal is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to handle emotionally charged conversations with clarity.                 | clarify appeal;<br>document appeal                                 | Contrast: appeal should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify appeal and the evidence that supports it.                                 |
| confidentiality        | In education administration, confidentiality is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to handle emotionally charged conversations with clarity.        | clarify confidentiality;<br>document confidentiality               | Contrast: confidentiality should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify confidentiality and the evidence that supports it.               |

## Faculty Coordination and Evaluation



| Term                     | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Collocations                                                        | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| rubric                   | In education administration, rubric is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to give faculty feedback without vague judgment.                   | clarify rubric; document rubric                                     | Contrast: rubric should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify rubric and the evidence that supports it.                                     |
| grading policy           | In education administration, grading policy is an approved rule or decision framework that sets what is permitted, required, or acceptable. Use it when teams need to give faculty feedback without vague judgment.         | apply the grading policy; comply with the grading policy            | Contrast: grading policy is an approved rule or threshold, not an informal preference. Example: Please confirm which grading policy applies before we commit the team.                                                                              |
| observation              | In education administration, observation is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to give faculty feedback without vague judgment.              | clarify observation; document observation                           | Contrast: observation should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify observation and the evidence that supports it.                           |
| professional development | In education administration, professional development is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to give faculty feedback without vague judgment. | clarify professional development; document professional development | Contrast: professional development should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify professional development and the evidence that supports it. |

## Compliance, Records, and Privacy

| Term            | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Collocations                                      | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FERPA           | In education administration, FERPA is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain record rules and student privacy.                      | clarify FERPA; document FERPA                     | Contrast: FERPA should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify FERPA and the evidence that supports it.                     |
| student record  | In education administration, student record is information that can be checked to support a claim, decision, investigation, or compliance conclusion. Use it when teams need to explain record rules and student privacy. | clarify student record; document student record   | Contrast: student record should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify student record and the evidence that supports it.   |
| need to know    | In education administration, need to know is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain record rules and student privacy.               | clarify need to know; document need to know       | Contrast: need to know should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify need to know and the evidence that supports it.       |
| secure handling | In education administration, secure handling is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain record rules and student privacy.            | clarify secure handling; document secure handling | Contrast: secure handling should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify secure handling and the evidence that supports it. |

## Accreditation and Program Review

| Term           | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Collocations                                              | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| accreditation  | External recognition that an organization meets defined quality, safety, or professional standards.                                                                                                                              | clarify accreditation;<br>document accreditation          | Contrast: accreditation should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify accreditation and the evidence that supports it. |
| program review | In education administration, program review is a structured course of action that assigns priorities, sequencing, assumptions, and responsible roles. Use it when teams need to use evidence language for institutional quality. | align on the program review;<br>revise the program review | Contrast: program review sets an intended course of action; it is not proof that the work is feasible or approved. Example: Before we revise the program review, we need to test the dependency and resource assumptions.     |
| evidence       | In education administration, evidence is information that can be checked to support a claim, decision, investigation, or compliance conclusion. Use it when teams need to use evidence language for institutional quality.       | clarify evidence;<br>document evidence                    | Contrast: evidence should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify evidence and the evidence that supports it.           |
| action plan    | In education administration, action plan is a structured course of action that assigns priorities, sequencing, assumptions, and responsible roles. Use it when teams need to use evidence language for institutional quality.    | align on the action plan;<br>revise the action plan       | Contrast: action plan sets an intended course of action; it is not proof that the work is feasible or approved. Example: Before we revise the action plan, we need to test the dependency and resource assumptions.           |

## Budget, Staffing, and Institutional Priorities

| Term           | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Collocations                                       | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| budget         | In education administration, budget is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss resource tradeoffs without mission drift.                   | clarify budget;<br>document budget                 | Contrast: budget should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify budget and the evidence that supports it.                 |
| staffing model | In education administration, staffing model is a defined information asset or analytical construct used to measure, explain, or predict an outcome. Use it when teams need to discuss resource tradeoffs without mission drift. | clarify staffing model;<br>document staffing model | Contrast: staffing model should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify staffing model and the evidence that supports it. |
| workload       | In education administration, workload is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss resource tradeoffs without mission drift.                 | clarify workload;<br>document workload             | Contrast: workload should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify workload and the evidence that supports it.             |
| sustainability | In education administration, sustainability is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss resource tradeoffs without mission drift.           | clarify sustainability;<br>document sustainability | Contrast: sustainability should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify sustainability and the evidence that supports it. |

## Industry-Specific Meeting Moves

| Situation                                      | Useful language                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Enrollment, Admissions, and Placement          | Before we commit, I want to confirm admissions criteria, placement, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If admission criteria, placement evidence, capacity, and equity need transparent handling., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step. |
| Curriculum Planning and Learning Outcomes      | Before we commit, I want to confirm learning outcome, curriculum map, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If standards, outcomes, sequence, assessment, and workload must align., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                   |
| Student Support and Intervention               | Before we commit, I want to confirm intervention, accommodation, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If attendance, assessment data, accommodations, behavior, and support plans need review., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.      |
| Parent and Guardian Communication              | Before we commit, I want to confirm guardian communication, discipline, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If facts, policy, student privacy, appeal options, and empathy must be balanced., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.       |
| Faculty Coordination and Evaluation            | Before we commit, I want to confirm rubric, grading policy, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If rubrics, grading policy, classroom evidence, and professional support are needed., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.               |
| Compliance, Records, and Privacy               | Before we commit, I want to confirm FERPA, student record, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If need-to-know access, secure handling, and privacy policy must be confirmed., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                      |
| Accreditation and Program Review               | Before we commit, I want to confirm accreditation, program review, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If evidence, assessment cycle, action plan, and ownership must be documented., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.               |
| Budget, Staffing, and Institutional Priorities | Before we commit, I want to confirm budget, staffing model, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If workload, student impact, compliance, and sustainability need evaluation., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                       |

## High-pressure pushback frames

- I understand the urgency. The risk is that we move faster than the evidence or process supports.
- I am not blocking the goal. I am naming the condition we need before the decision is safe and credible.
- If we accept this risk, we should name the owner, document the assumption, and define the trigger for escalation.
- That may be possible, but not under the current scope, timeline, or approval path.
- Let's separate what we know, what we assume, and what still needs confirmation.

## Assessment and Coaching

### Performance rubric

| Skill                  | Developing                                           | Proficient                                               | Strong                                                                                    |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Terminology            | Recognizes terms but uses them loosely.              | Uses field terms accurately in context.                  | Defines terms, connects them to evidence, and explains decision impact.                   |
| Pushback               | Disagrees vaguely or avoids disagreement.            | Names concern with evidence and next step.               | Balances urgency, relationship, risk, owner, and decision rights.                         |
| Scenario judgment      | Focuses on one stakeholder's preference.             | Identifies constraint, risk, and process.                | Guides the group toward a documented, realistic decision.                                 |
| Decision communication | Selects language without linking it to the decision. | Chooses language that names facts, owner, and next step. | Distinguishes evidence, tradeoff, authority, and escalation in a decision-ready response. |

## Source orientation

- Institutional policies and student-record privacy rules.
- Accreditation and curriculum standards.
- Local education regulations and student-support procedures.
- The learner's own company policies, SOPs, contracts, systems, templates, and approved communication standards.